

Radio Shack[®]

A Division of Tandy Corporation

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TANDY INTRODUCES DESKMATE 3.0 INTEGRATED SOFTWARE

FORT WORTH, TEXAS -- Tandy Corporation, the leading manufacturer of PC-compatible computers, today unveiled DeskMate[®] 3.0, a new version of Tandy's popular, integrated productivity software for Tandy[®] computers and other PC-compatibles.

"This product represents the next step in making computers significantly easier to use," said John V. Roach, chief executive officer, chairman of the board and president of Tandy Corporation, "while at the same time reducing the software cost of owning a PC."

First introduced in 1984, DeskMate has evolved into a graphically-oriented user interface designed to bring a consistent look and feel of keyboard and mouse commands to diverse applications. As a result, the learning time required for each new software package is significantly reduced.

This affordable interface is supplied with a wide array of practical applications for low-cost personal computers in the home and business markets. Software publishers who have licensed the DeskMate interface and have committed to provide programs that run under this environment include Activision, Broderbund, Digital Learning Systems, Electronic Arts, Epyx, First Byte, Intuit, The Learning Company, Sierra Online, Quantum Computer Systems, Software Publishing Corporation, Star Software and Symantec.

In addition to the graphic interface, DeskMate 3.0 includes several basic applications. TEXT is an easy-to-use text entry and editing system that includes a 90,000 word spell checker,

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centering, headers, footers, boldface and underline. Form letters created in TEXT can be personalized by merging information from the ADDRESS application.

ADDRESS is a "card file" program which includes fields for name, address, work phone number, home phone number, dates to remember and notes. Names in the file may be designated as members of sub-lists, such as a Christmas card list or PTA members, by simply entering the information in the "Member Of" category. Up to 25 sub-lists may be specified by the user and accessed as if they were separate address book files. The number of individual records is limited only by the amount of disk space on the computer.

Additionally, phone numbers entered in ADDRESS are automatically added to the PHONE list accessory in DeskMate so the user can easily look up and automatically dial, through use of a modem, home or business phone numbers from within any part of DeskMate.

An event-oriented CALENDAR graphically displays yearly, monthly, weekly and daily events with the ability to include "Annual Occasions," such as birthdays and anniversaries; "Reminders," which will appear each day until removed by the user; and "Notes," which are attached to a particular day but with no specific time.

DeskMate users can get immediate information regarding the day's events without going into the CALENDAR by placing a THINGS TO DO box on the desktop. Information from the CALENDAR, such as meetings, reminders and notes for the current day, automatically appear in the THINGS TO DO box. As the user moves in and out of DeskMate during the day, the list is updated and scheduled events are automatically removed as their time passes.

A 16-color DRAW application allows the user to flip, rotate and zoom-in on artwork or sections of it, as well as cut, copy and paste clip art into a TEXT document.

The DeskMate desktop is fully configurable and any application not included with DeskMate 3.0 may be added automatically using the AUTOCONFIG box on the desktop. By simply placing the application diskette into the floppy drive and pulling down the file menu to

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update the screen, the user can replace the AUTOCONFIG box with the desired application. Anytime the application is placed in the floppy drive, the AUTOCONFIG file will be read by the computer and the application will automatically appear on the DeskMate desktop.

PC-LINKSM provides the needed software to access a new online communications service designed for ease-of-use and to help owners of Tandy computers, and other PC-compatibles, get the most from their PCs. It utilizes DeskMate's graphical user interface while on line so the user can navigate easily using a series of pull-down menus and pop-up dialogue boxes rather than typed commands. This service provides unlimited usage from 6 p.m. to 6 a.m. for the low monthly rate of \$9.95.

Other applications included with DeskMate are WORKSHEET, a 99-row by 99-column spreadsheet; FILER and FORM SETUP, which allow the user to create personal databases such as home inventory and recipes; and HELP, which contains a "Quick Reference" guide listing several subject areas including three tutorials to aid the user in becoming familiar with the keyboard, a mouse and DeskMate desktop.

To test spelling skills, an electronic version of the popular HANGMAN word game is included. Words are automatically selected from DeskMate's spell checker.

To take advantage of the built-in audio "input and output" capabilities of the new Tandy^R 1000 SL and TL computers, MUSIC and SOUND applications, which use the familiar DeskMate interface and are included with these computers.

MUSIC is a simple composition program which includes several instrumental voices which can be played individually or as a chord.

For added creativity, the SOUND program utilizes the digital-to-analog and analog-to-digital converters built into the 1000 SL and TL computers. A microphone can be plugged into either of these computers to record various sounds including speech and music. Once converted to digital format, sections can be cut, pasted, reversed or overlayed with other sounds. In order

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to save disk space, SOUND files are automatically compressed when saved.

Available in the fourth quarter of 1988, the DeskMate Workgroup Companion (Cat. No. 25-1251) is a supplemental product that provides connectivity and resource sharing for workgroups of two or more people. Some of the special features and applications include shared calendar, address book and printer, mail, 3+^R to facilitate the interface and management of access to a 3Com^R network, 3Com/TandyLinkTM Mail Bridge to transfer mail to and from Tandy's network and a 3Com workgroup solution, remote access and remote program loading.

Owners of previous DeskMate versions, such as DeskMate^R II or Personal DeskMate,TM receive a \$50 credit towards the purchase of DeskMate 3.0 by taking the front cover of their DeskMate manual to a participating Radio Shack^R retail outlet.

The stand-alone version of DeskMate 3.0 (Cat. No. 25-1250) for Tandy^R computers and other PCs is now available and has a suggested retail price of \$99.95. The stand-alone version of PC-Link (Cat. No. 25-1255) has a suggested retail price of \$29.95 and Workgroup Companion has a suggested retail price of \$149.95. Prices are good at Radio Shack Computer Centers, Plus Computer Centers,^R and participating stores and dealers nationwide.

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